Spotted App: What's Left

Step by step, like you're 5 · 30 Oct 2026 · Goal: live on iPhone + Android on **1 January 2027**

Where you are: the screens are about **70–80% done** (sign-in, 5 tabs, place page, influencer page, filters, Add Place from Instagram, nearby-alert code, 53 tests). What's left is **making it real and getting it into the stores**. The places and offers are sample data, and sign-in is a demo (code 123456).

The biggest danger to 1 Jan: Google makes new personal accounts run a **closed test with 12+ testers for 14 days** before you can publish. Apple review can take **1–7 days**. So **both stores must have your app by about 10 December**. Work backwards from that date.

The big picture (in order)

#	Step	Cost	Finish by
1	Make your store accounts (Apple + Google) + Expo account	Apple ~AED 365/yr · Google ~AED 92 once · Expo free	**This week**
2	Update the app's rule book (SPEC.md)	Free	2 Nov
3	Health check: run the tests	Free	2 Nov
4	Make a "development build" in the cloud and put it on your phone	Free (EAS free plan)	9 Nov
5	**Walk test**: does the nearby alert really work with the app closed?	Free	16 Nov
6	Decide what to do about sign-in	Free	16 Nov
7	Privacy policy online + permission texts	Free	23 Nov
8	Store pages: screenshots, description, location video	Free	30 Nov
9	Testers: Google closed test (12+ people, 14 days) + Apple TestFlight	Free	**Start by 26 Nov**
10	Submit to both stores, fix any rejection	Free	10–20 Dec
11	Set both to release on 1 Jan	Free	1 Jan

Step 1 · Make your accounts (you do this, about 1 hour)

Apple Developer (for iPhone)

1. On your phone or laptop, go to **developer.apple.com/programs/enroll**.
2. Sign in with your Apple ID (turn on two-step login if it asks).
3. Choose **Individual**. This is cheapest and easiest. "Organisation" needs a trade licence and a D-U-N-S number, so skip it for now.
4. Pay **USD 99 (~AED 365) a year**. Approval takes 1–2 days.

Google Play Console (for Android)

1. Go to **play.google.com/console/signup** and choose **Yourself** (personal).
2. Pay **USD 25 (~AED 92) once**. Upload your Emirates ID or passport when it asks. Approval can take a few days.

Expo (free, builds your app in the cloud so your laptop stays cool)

1. Go to **expo.dev/signup** and make a free account with your Spotted email.
2. Go to **Account settings → Access tokens → Create token**. Name it "claude". **Copy it somewhere safe.** You'll paste it into Claude Code in Step 4.

Step 2 · Open your app in Claude Code and update the rule book

1. Go to **claude.ai/code** in your browser.
2. Choose the repository **sarahnazirahmed-debug/Spotted**.
3. Paste this:

COPY INTO CLAUDE CODE

Update SPEC.md, CLAUDE.md and README with these decisions, then show me what changed:
- Launch on iPhone and Android on the same day, 1 January 2027 (not Android first).
- Launch area: Khalifa City, Abu Dhabi (works worldwide).
- Brand colours: purple #6A1FB0, deep #3C096C, red #E5383B, lilac #C9A2FF, yellow #FFD23F. Font: Poppins only.
- Version 1 at launch = core only: save from a reel, saved list, map, nearby alerts, settings, delete my data.
- Home circles, New In, offers, loyalty and the budget filter stay in the code but are hidden behind an on/off switch in one file (src/config/features.ts), all set to OFF for launch.
- Partner free trial is 2 months. Creator Pro is AED 249/month. User membership is called "Spotted Select". Points are called "Pins": 1 Pin for every AED 15 spent, and leftover money carries over (AED 12 + AED 18 = AED 30 = 2 Pins).

Run npm run check and commit with the message "Update plan for 1 Jan launch".

✓ What you should see: a short list of changes, "all tests passed", and "committed".

Step 3 · Health check

COPY INTO CLAUDE CODE

Run npm run check. Then go through the "Done means" checklist in SPEC.md section 12 and tell me, for each line, whether the code is ready, needs work, or needs me to test on a real phone. Keep it short.

✓ You get a checklist. Fix anything marked "needs work" one at a time with: "Fix item 3 from your list."

Step 4 · Put the real app on your phone (development build)

> **Why:** the Expo Go app can't run background location. A **development build** is your own private copy of Spotted that can. It is built in Expo's cloud, not on your laptop.

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I want a development build for Android and iPhone using EAS cloud builds (not on my computer). I will paste my Expo access token when you ask; store it as the EXPO_TOKEN secret, never in the code. Set up eas.json if needed, start the Android build first, then the iPhone build, and give me the install links. Tell me in simple steps how to install each one on my phone.

1. When it asks, paste your **Expo token** from Step 1.
2. For iPhone it will ask you to log in to your **Apple Developer** account and register your phone. Follow its steps.
3. Open the link on your phone and install.

✓ **The Spotted app icon is on your phone and opens without Expo Go.**

Step 5 · The walk test (the most important test)

1. Open Spotted and **save a real place 1–2 km from home** (a café or supermarket).
2. When it asks for location, choose **"Allow all the time"** (Android) or **"Always"** (iPhone). Allow notifications.
3. **Close the app fully**: swipe it away.
4. Walk or drive towards the place with your phone in your pocket.
5. You should get: **"[Place] is 1 km away — you saved it from a reel."**
6. Do it again the same day. You should **not** get a second alert (1 per place per day).

If it doesn't work, tell Claude Code: *"The nearby alert didn't arrive on my [iPhone/Android]. The app was closed, location was set to Always, and I was about 500 m away. Help me find out why."*

> **Do this test on both phones.** If you only have one phone, borrow one from a family member for 1 day.

Step 6 · Sign-in: decide before launch

Right now everyone's code is **123456**. That's fine for testing, but **not for real users**. Your choices:

Option	Cost	Work	My view
A. No sign-in at launch. The app opens straight to Home, and data stays on the phone.	Free	Very small	**Recommended for 1 Jan.** Data is only on the phone anyway, so login does nothing yet.
B. Email code login (Supabase, free plan)	Free	Medium	Good for later, when partners need accounts (2028).
C. Real SMS codes	Pay per SMS	Medium	Skip. It costs money for every login.

For option A, paste: *"Hide the sign-in screens behind the features switch (OFF) so the app opens on Home after the welcome slides. Keep the code for later. Run npm run check and commit."*

Step 7 · Privacy policy + permission texts

COPY INTO CLAUDE CODE

Read docs/PRIVACY_POLICY.md and make sure it explains in plain words: background location (why and how it's used), notifications, that saved places stay on the phone, and how to delete everything. Then check the location permission texts in app.json say: "Spotted reminds you when you're near a place you saved. We need your location, even when the app is closed, to do this." Commit.

The policy must be on a web page. Put it on your website as **spotted.ae/privacy** (see the Website PDF, Step 9). Until the domain is bought, the free Vercel link works.

Step 8 · Store pages

1. **Screenshots:** paste *"Make App Store and Google Play screenshots of Spotted (Home, Saved, Map, Place page, nearby alert) in brand colours with short headlines, no faces. Sizes for iPhone 6.9-inch and Android phone. Save as PNG in /store."*
2. **Text:** paste *"Write the App Store and Google Play listing: name 'Spotted: Save places from reels', subtitle, short and long description, keywords, and the 'why we need background location' note for reviewers."*
3. **Location video (both stores ask for it):** screen-record your phone for 30 seconds. Save a place, show the "Always" permission, then show the alert arriving. Upload it to YouTube as **Unlisted** and keep the link.

Step 9 · Testers (start by 26 November!)

Google closed test

1. Ask Claude Code: *"Make a production Android build (AAB) with EAS and tell me how to upload it to a Closed testing track in Google Play Console."*
2. In Play Console: **Testing → Closed testing → Create track**, then upload the file.
3. Add **15 Gmail addresses** (friends, family, nursery colleagues). Send them the opt-in link.
4. They must keep the app installed and open it most days for **14 days**.

Apple TestFlight

1. Ask: *"Make an iPhone production build with EAS and submit it to TestFlight."*
2. In **appstoreconnect.apple.com → TestFlight**, add up to 10 testers by email.

> **Tip:** make a WhatsApp group "Spotted testers". Every few days ask: *"Did you get an alert? Did anything crash?"*

Step 10 · Submit (about 10 December)

1. Google: **Production → Create release**. Fill the **Data safety** form (location: yes, not shared, used for the app's main feature) and the **background location** form with your YouTube link.
2. Apple: in App Store Connect, add the listing, screenshots and privacy answers. Pick the build and press **Submit for review**. Add a note for reviewers explaining the nearby alert.
3. If either rejects it, **copy the rejection message into Claude Code** and say "fix this".

Step 11 · Launch day

- Set Apple to **"Manually release this version"** and press release at **12:05 am, 1 Jan**.
- Google: use **Managed publishing** and publish at the same time.
- Put both store links in your Instagram bio and on the website.

After launch (don't build now)

Accounts with real login · business and creator sign-up · offers · QR scan at the counter · stars · stamp cards · **Pins** (1 per AED 15, leftover carries over) · **Spotted Select**. Each one gets switched on in **src/config/features.ts** when it's ready.

> **Honest check:** if by **1 December** the walk test still fails on either phone, launch date risk is high. Consider launching **Android first on 1 Jan and iPhone a few weeks later** rather than skipping the test. A broken alert ruins first impressions.